The what, why and how of (mixed) digital methods

Digital methods lecture 1

Course responsible: Hjalmar Bang Carlsen, Associate Professor SODAS. hc@sodas.ku.dk

Introduction to the teaching team

- Julie Hvidsteen hsl448@sodas.ku.dk
- Csilla Duray cd@plen.ku.dk
- Mihaela Capriean xbk406@sodas.ku.dk
- Tereza Blazkova tereza.blazkova@sodas.ku.dk

Overview of the lecture

1. Start with the end
2. What is (mixed) digital methods?
3. Why (mixed) digital methods?
4. How (mixed) digital methods?

Let start with the end!

- Digital Mixed Methods Project of 25 pages
- Collect and use digital data to answer a self-chosen research question
- Applied both qual and quant analysis

Exam hand-in - Focus

- digital mixed method research design
- netnography
- computer assisted qualitative text analysis
- simple quantitative analysis
- integration between qual and quant text analysis

Exam hand-in - Must haves

- A description of the datasite informed by netnography
- A description of the data collection
- A description of the research design
- A qualitative text analysis,
- A quantitative text analysis,
- A computational classification must be validated using a manual coded test set

Exam hand-in - Prototype

1. Introduction(1 page)
2. Background: introducing topic and datasite(s)(1,5 pages)
3. Theory and literature.(2 pages)
4. Design (1-2 pages)
5. Data collection (1-2 pages)
6. Methods(1-2 pages)
7. Analysis(6-8 pages)
8. conclusion(1-2 pages)

Examples of last year projects

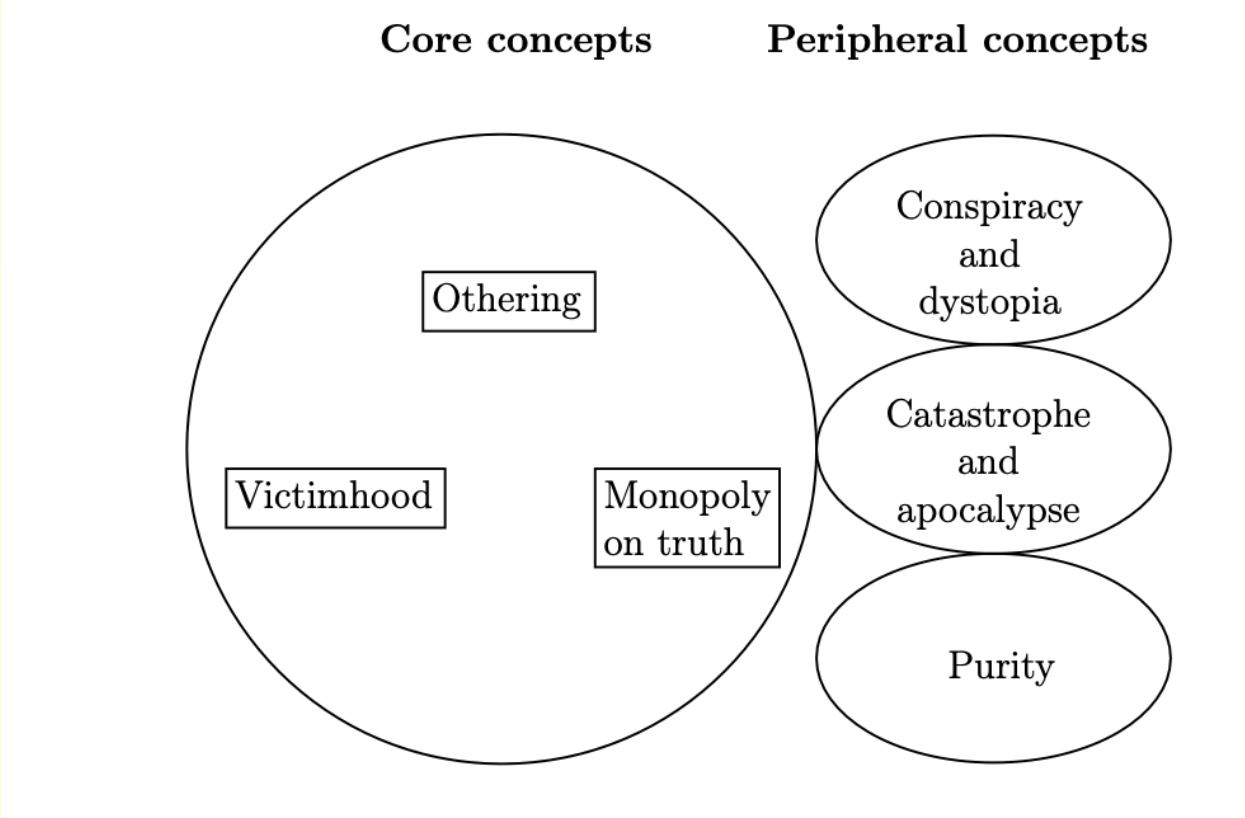
1. Incels and Extremism
2. How Ukrainian Military Brigades Mobilize Support Through Social Media

Incels and Extremism: Research question

Research question:

What tenets in incel culture resemble the structure of extremist ideology?

Conceptual focus:



Incels and Extremism: Datasite and Data collection

Datasite:

Data collection:

Incels and Extremism: Text analysis

Qualitative analysis:

"*I am the worst of the worst. I don't deserve to mate and breed. If a woman took pity and bore my offspring, it would destroy her life.*"_____

In this case, his victimhood is not derived from previous rejections or his treatment by women in the past, but a self-deprecation he is placing upon himself.

Quantitative analysis:

Table 2: Relative Frequencies of Subthemes

Subtheme	Relative Frequency (%)
Othering	18.20
Victimhood	2.84
Monopoly on Truth	4.00
Self-hatred	5.90
Purity	1.08
Residuals	67.98

What is *digital* methods?

1. In terms of data?

Repurposing of digital traces

What is digital methods?

1. In terms of data?

Repurposing of digital traces

What is digital methods?

1. In terms of data?

Repurposing of digital traces

2. In terms of methods?

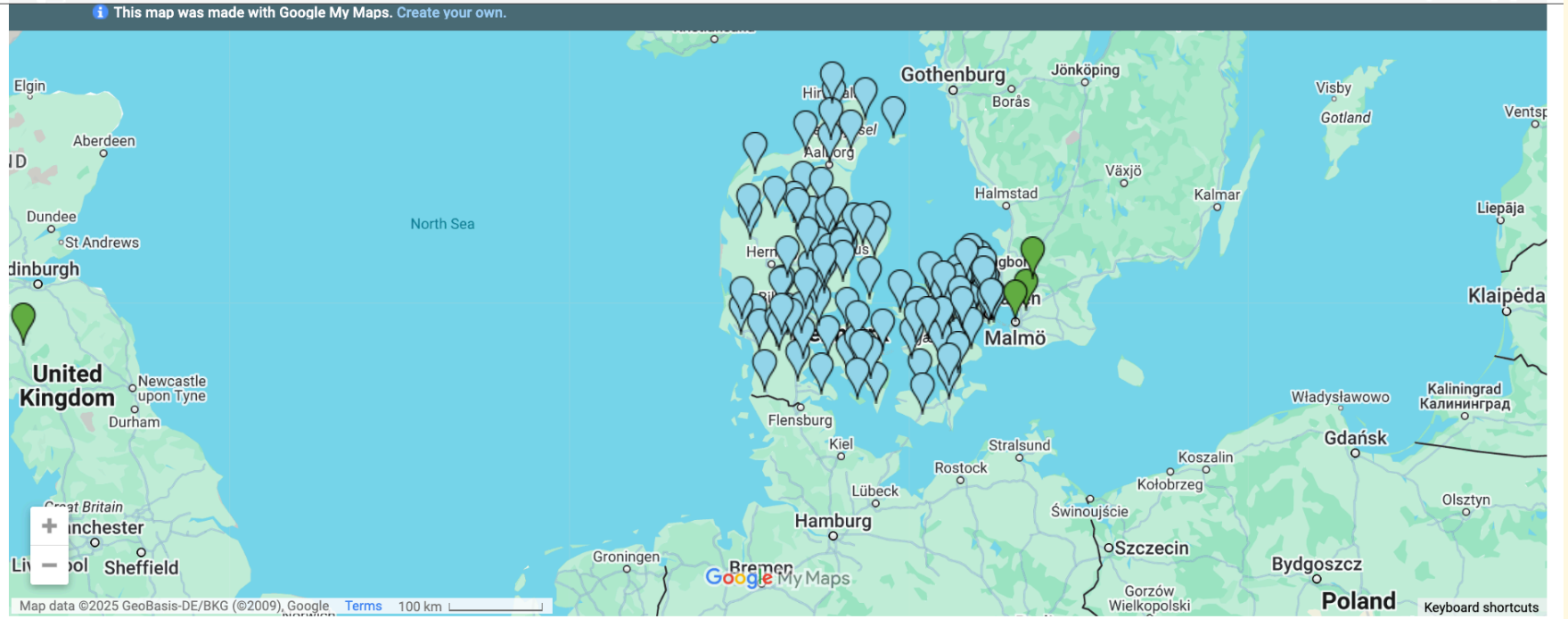
Learning from methods of the medium

Esben Bøgh Sørensen @EsbenBoegh · 3 Jun 2020

A big crowd in Aarhus, Denmark **#blm**

Translate with DeepL

3 7 56



A – J

Venligboerne Aalestrup og Omegn
https://www.facebook.com/groups/1000073450011594/

Venligboerne Aabenraa
https://www.facebook.com/groups/707174566060710/

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Venligboerne Kokkedal
https://www.facebook.com/groups/115447522127887/

Venligboerne Kolding
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What is digital methods?

1. In terms of data?

Repurposing of digital traces

2. In terms of methods?

Learning from methods of the medium

3. In terms of analysis?

Interpretative analysis of quantitative patterns

Network of Hyperlinks

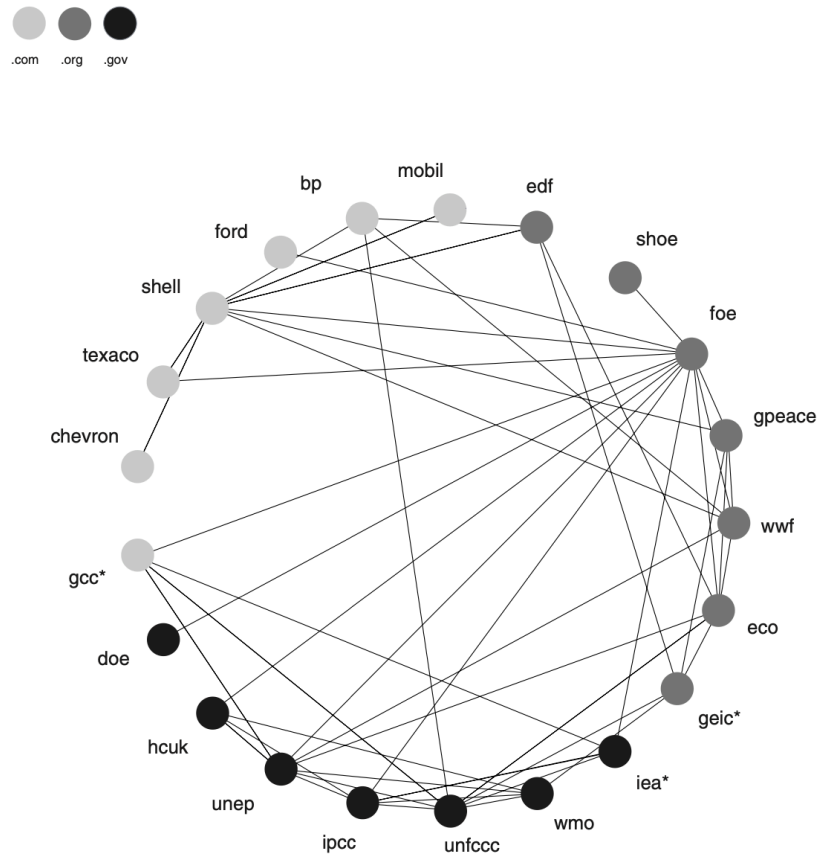
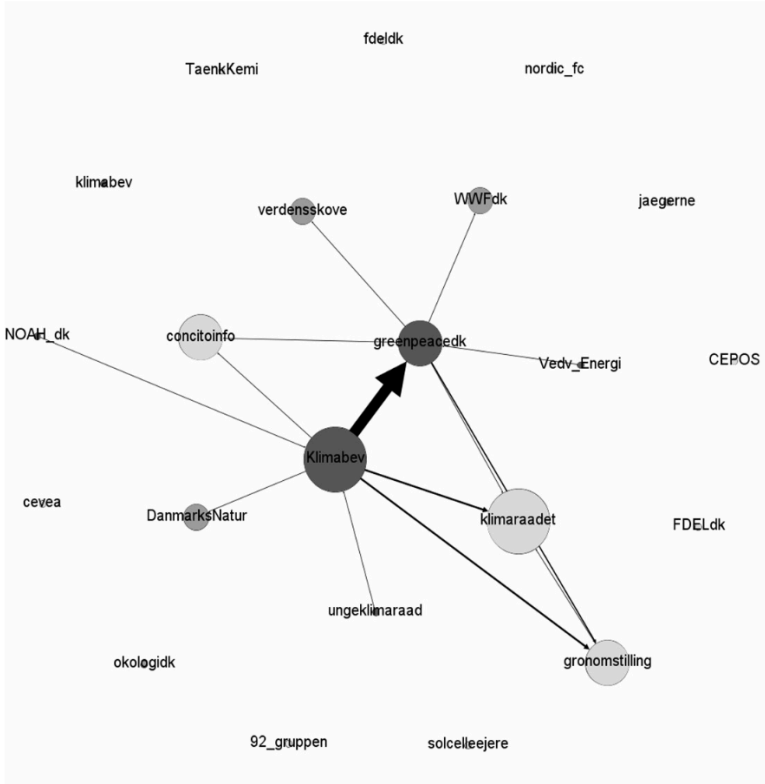


Figure 1. *Hyperlink Mother map*. Sample of the actors in the climate change debate on the web in November 1998, without direction of hyperlinking.

Network of retweets

Figure 2: Retweet network among Danish green NGOs, Spring 2020



What is digital methods?

- a methodology that seeks **learn from methods of the medium**, that is the methods embedded in online devices.
- The purpose is **not** to fine-tune them, this is better left to computer scientists.
- Yet, the goal is to use them to **investigate wider cultural dynamics**, while taking **medium specificity** seriously.

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1. In terms of data?

Combines qual(text) and quant(numbers) data

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Combines qual(text) and quant(numbers) data

2. In terms of methods?

Combines qual(interviews) and quant(surveys)

3. In terms of analysis?

Interpretive AND analytical/statistical

What is *mixed* methods?

- **mixed data-collection studies** those based on at least two kinds of data (such as field notes and administrative records) or two means of collecting them (such as interviewing and controlled experimentation).
- **mixed data-analysis studies** those that, regardless of the number of data sources, either employ more than one analytical technique or cross techniques and types of data (such as using regression to analyze interview transcripts).

Small 2011

What is *mixed digital* methods?

1. In terms of data?

Repurpose and combine qual and quant digital traces

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2. In terms of methods?

Combines qual(netnography) and quant(web-scraping)

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Combines qual(netnography) and quant(web-scraping)

3. In terms of analysis?

Interpretive AND analytical/statistical(both comp assisted)

Why Mixed digital methods?

1. In terms of data

- qual in format and quant in scale
- Bad for qual, bad for quant, but good for mixed
- Digital data generated from specific socio-tecnical situations

Why Mixed digital methods?

1. In terms of data

Data is pretty mixed

2. In terms of methods

Needs to be both contextual, flexible and scalable

Why Mixed digital methods?

1. In terms of data

Data is pretty mixed

2. In terms of method

Needs to be both contextual, flexible and scalable

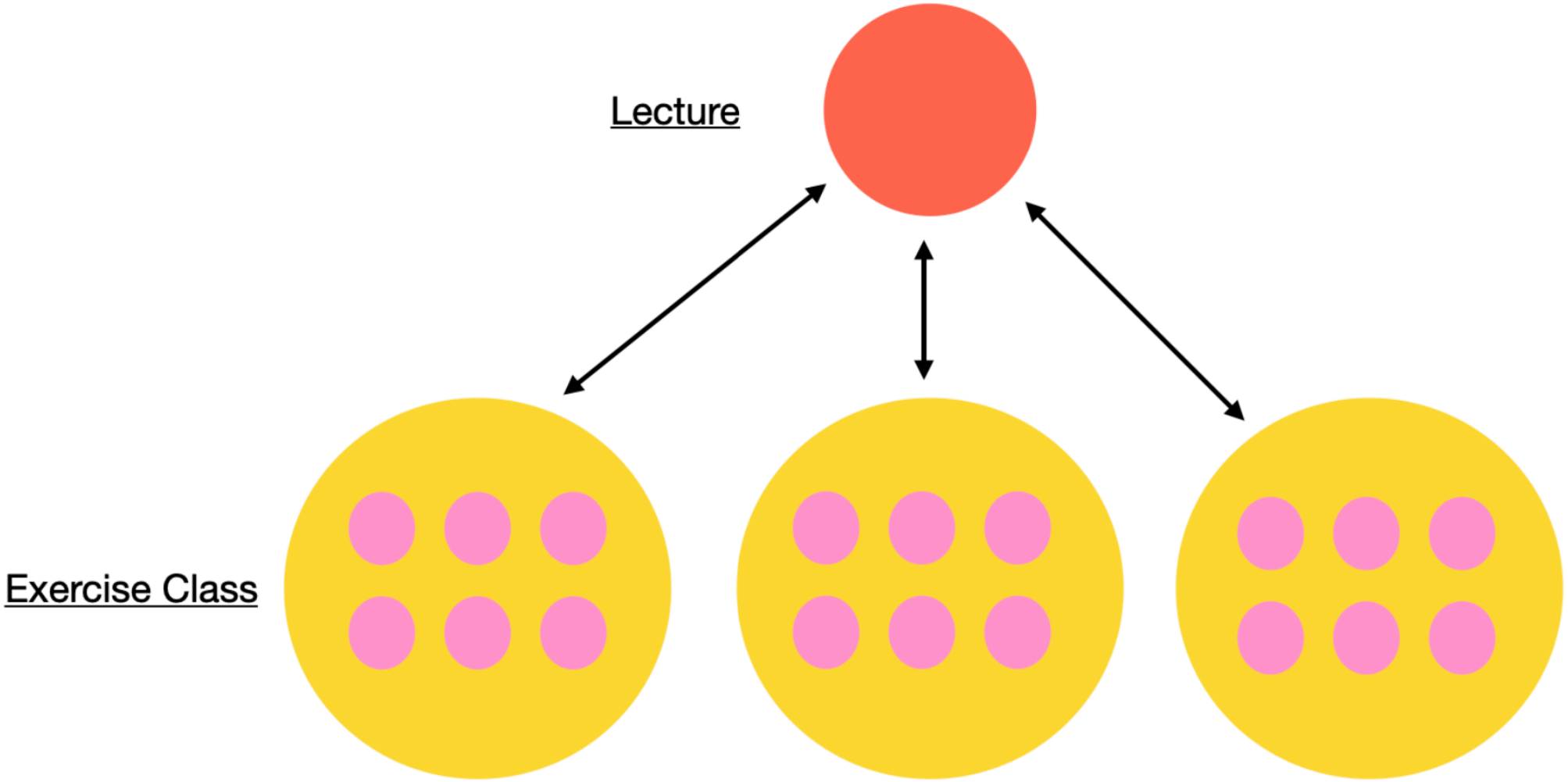
3. **In terms of analysis**

- **Quant and qual gets it wrong without being mixed**
- **Quant and qual gets lost without being mixed**

How Mixed Digital Methods?

Digital Methods course as a research collective

- The whole class as research a research collective studying interesting and important stuff using mixed digital methods
- Each exercise class as research cluster around certain topics, composed of multiple project groups doing their own independent research project.


Lecture
Exercise Class

Exercise classes

- Groups will present one slide update every Tuesday(starting after Easter)
- Do a lot of group work
- Get feedback on the 4 Milestones
- Potentially do small exercises.

Supervision sessions

- 6 supervision sessions per group of 25 min each.
- Short update on the project and current challenges
- My office on the SODAS hallway

Course outline

Lecture	Exercises
1. Research questions, research design, datasite	Get into groups, formulate a question, find datasites
2. Data design, Data collection and Sampling	Data collection
3. data exploration and open coding	Open coding session, data analysis design
4. Computer assisted focused coding and text classification	focused coding session, codebook, data analysis design
5. Text classification (continued) and Quantitative (text analysis)	Work on data analysis continued
6. Mixed digital methods design of Analysis	Design Mixed Analysis, data analysis

The group-formation-and-topic-selection process

- For those that need to form groups. Go to CSS 35-3-13. TAs Julie and Csilla will coordinate a group formation session. Use the google sheet to look for and note down topic of interest.
- For those in groups you will either go to 2-2-49(Tereza) or 2-2-55(Mihaela). Goal to find topic, research question and do initial scouting for data-sites.
- You should have found group and topic by 16. April. We will make exercise classes of shared topical interest starting 22. April.